

ACTIVITY 1 — FACILITATOR GUIDE

Yellow Belt Role, Certification Paths, and Improvement Scenario

TYPE	DURATION	DMAIC PHASE	MAPS TO
Core Activity	30 min	FOUNDATIONS	A1

Purpose of this activity

Explain the Yellow Belt role and select a suitable improvement scenario (A1).

Establish what a Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt is accountable for, how the belt pathway progresses from White to Master Black Belt, and choose a small, manageable improvement scenario to carry through the whole course.

What learners produce

A Yellow Belt responsibility table, a belt-pathway comparison and a selected improvement scenario justified against all four criteria.

Materials required

- Learner Worksheet (one per learner)
- Checklist (one per group)
- A laptop with Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc
- The CSV files in this activity's data/ and templates/ folders
- Flipchart or A3 sheet and markers
- The course slides for the scenario and the framework

Set-up

Groups of 3-5. Distribute one worksheet per learner and one checklist per group. Every activity runs on the same continuous Contoso Service Desk scenario, so remind learners where this one sits in that story before starting.

Scenario / briefing material

Contoso Service Desk handles employee IT requests. Employees complain that tickets take too long to be assigned, that they must keep chasing for status, and that agents apply different definitions of what counts as "resolved". Handoffs between the front line and the specialist queues are unclear, and although ticket data exists it is inconsistent. You are supporting the improvement team as a Yellow Belt — you do not lead the project.

Two weeks of data have been collected: 400 tickets, of which 96 contained at least one defect, with 120 defects recorded in total across 6 defect opportunities per ticket. Mean assignment time is 55 minutes (median 46) against a 30-minute improvement goal. The CSV files in this activity's data/ folder are that extract.

Files in this activity folder

data/ — the mock data you analyse:

- service-desk-tickets.csv — 400 rows (ticket_id, date, ticket_type, channel, assigned_queue, agent, assignment_time_min, met_30min_goal, defect_count, defect_categories, reopened)

templates/ — the worksheets you complete:

- belt-pathway-comparison.csv (belt, typical_role, training_days, leads_or_supports, typical_project_scope)
- project-selection-criteria.csv (criterion, does_the_scenario_meet_it, evidence)
- yellow-belt-responsibilities.csv (responsibility, your_contribution, belt_that_leads_it)

Open these in Excel, Google Sheets or LibreOffice Calc. Work on a copy so the originals stay clean for revision.

The scenario brief and the two weeks of ticket data are in data/.

How to run it — step by step

#	Instruction to learners	Facilitator note
1	Define the Yellow Belt role — list at least four responsibilities and your contribution to each.	Learners routinely overstate the Yellow Belt role — push back on 'I would lead the project'.
2	Compare the White, Yellow, Green, Black and Master Black Belt pathways in a table.	If a learner picks their own scenario, check it is small enough to finish in the course.
3	Review the Contoso Service Desk scenario: tickets are slow to be assigned and status is unclear.	The belt table is often copied from memory — insist on the CSSC pathway, not a guess.
4	Test your scenario against the 'good project' criteria — day-to-day work, manageable, aligned to business goals, data available.	
5	Record why a Yellow Belt supports rather than leads this improvement.	

Suggested timing

Minutes	Phase
3 min	Brief the Contoso scenario
8 min	List Yellow Belt responsibilities
8 min	Compare the five belt pathways
8 min	Test the scenario against the four criteria
3 min	Agree why a Yellow Belt supports rather than leads

Total: 30 minutes

Discussion & decision prompts

1. Where does a Yellow Belt add the most value on a DMAIC project, and where should they hand over?
2. Which of the four 'good project' criteria is most often ignored in your own workplace?
3. What would make the Contoso scenario a BAD Six Sigma project?

Debrief

Bring the class back together and draw out the learning:

- Ask two or three groups to show what they produced, not just what they concluded.
- Ask what surprised them — the gap between what they assumed and what the data showed.
- Link the activity explicitly back to the FOUNDATIONS phase of DMAIC.
- Remind learners this activity rehearses what the Case Study assessment will require.

Reflection questions:

- Name one process at your workplace that would pass all four selection criteria.
- What would you need permission for before collecting data on it?

Facilitator notes — what to watch for

- Learners routinely overstate the Yellow Belt role — push back on 'I would lead the project'.
- If a learner picks their own scenario, check it is small enough to finish in the course.
- The belt table is often copied from memory — insist on the CSSC pathway, not a guess.

Success criterion

You can state the Yellow Belt role in one sentence and justify your scenario against all four selection criteria.

Assessment link

This activity builds the FOUNDATIONS phase of DMAIC. All activities are in-class activities assessed indirectly through the open-book Case Study (CS), which reuses the same techniques on the same Contoso Service Desk scenario and the same figures (400 tickets, yield 76%, DPMO 50,000). Knowledge is assessed in the Written Assessment (WA-SAQ). Nothing is assessed that is not practised here or taught in the slides.